

TEAM INFORMATION

Rounders Competition

Group matches Wednesday and Thursday | Final: Thursday 8:00 pm

30 minutes per match	6 players per team	3 umpires one from each BB Company
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GRAND FINAL

Thursday 8:00 pm

Competition format

Groups. Eight teams are split into two groups of four. Each team plays every other team in its group once.

Teams. Teams field six players and may be made up of Leaders, Seniors and Company members. Reserves are allowed.

Finalists. The Group A winner and Group B winner play in the final on Thursday at 20:00.

Match length. Each match lasts 30 minutes. Each team has one batting innings of 15 minutes. Teams change over immediately when time is called; there is no half-time break.

Between games. There are 10 minutes between fixtures. Teams should use this changeover to move to the correct venue, swap over and take a drink before the next match starts.

Venues. Every team has at least one outdoor group game.

Groups

Group A	Group B
2nd Rochdale A	Misc (2nd Rochdale / 82nd Belfast)
82nd Belfast A	82nd Belfast B
6th Doncaster A	82nd Belfast C
6th Doncaster B	6th Doncaster C

Wednesday fixtures

Time	Sports barn	Outside
20:00 to 20:30	Misc versus Doncaster C	Rochdale A versus Belfast A
20:40 to 21:10	Rochdale A versus Doncaster A	Misc versus Belfast C
21:20 to 21:50	Rochdale A versus Doncaster B	None
22:00 to 22:30	Misc versus Belfast B	None

Thursday group fixtures

Time	Sports barn	Outside
11:00 to 11:30	Belfast B versus Belfast C	Belfast A versus Doncaster A
11:40 to 12:10	Belfast A versus Doncaster B	Belfast B versus Doncaster C
12:20 to 12:50	Belfast C versus Doncaster C	Doncaster A versus Doncaster B

Colour key: **Group A** **Group B**

Final

Time	Venue	Fixture
Thursday 20:00 to 20:30	Sports barn	GROUP A WINNER versus GROUP B WINNER

Competition rules

Bowling. The ball must be bowled underarm only. Overarm bowling is not allowed.

Running. Runners go around the outside of the posts, following the running line. Only one runner is allowed at each post at a time. Runners must not overtake the player ahead of them, including where that player is held up or waiting at a post.

Scoring. A batter scores one rounder for hitting the ball and running the full circuit back to the start. A batter scores half a rounder for hitting the ball and reaching second or third post, or for running the full circuit without having hit the ball.

Out. A batter or runner is out if: the ball is caught before it touches the ground; the post they are running to is stumped (a fielder holds the ball at that post) before they reach it; they overtake another runner; or they run inside the posts instead of around the outside.

No contact. There must be no deliberate physical contact between players. Any player who makes deliberate contact is disqualified from that game. If three players from the same team are disqualified in one game, the whole team is disqualified from that game.

Weaker hand (fair play handicap). To keep batting fair between age groups, an older batter must bat with their weaker hand (a right-handed player bats left-handed, and a left-handed player bats right-handed) in these situations: a Senior batting against a Company or Junior bowler; a Leader batting against a Senior, Company or Junior bowler; and a Company member batting against a Junior bowler. In all other cases players bat with their normal hand.

Leader participation

Batting. Leaders may bat, but they do not run. When a Leader bats, a Senior or Company member is designated to run the circuit on their behalf.

Fielding. Leaders may field or bowl, but they cannot field on a post or base, and cannot stand in the running line, so that the running route stays clear.

Posts and bases. All post and base positions are taken by Seniors or Company members, not by Leaders.

Umpires. Leaders must not override an umpire's decision, except on safety grounds, where a Leader may always step in.

Disputes. Any dispute over scoring or judging should be brought to the Centre Warden.

Spirit of the game. Being competitive is good, but this competition is for fun. Please play, and support, in that spirit.

Safeguarding

A no-contact sport. This is a no-contact competition. Players of all ages and abilities are welcome to take part, but there must be no physical contact between players at any time. Everyone is asked to play safely and look after one another on the pitch.

Names and records. The online scoring and fixtures system records team results only. No individual player, young person or Leader names are stored against teams, fixtures or scores at any point.

Umpiring

Three umpires. Each game has three umpires: one from 6th Doncaster, one from 82nd Belfast and one from 2nd Rochdale.

Decisions. Where a decision is disputed, the three umpires vote on it and the majority decision is final. If the dispute concerns scoring or judging, it should be brought to the Centre Warden rather than argued on the pitch.

First aid and incidents

First aid. First aid is provided by Group First Aiders. At least one Group First Aider and a minimum of two Officers must be present at each game. The Centre Warden provides backup.

Incidents. All incidents, injuries or near-misses must be reported to the Centre Warden as soon as possible so they can be recorded and acted on.

Risk assessment - Sports barn

Hazard	Controls
Bat / ball impact	Clear batting area. Waiting players and spectators kept behind the safety line.
Ball rebound off walls	The ball can rebound off barn walls at speed. Keep fielders and waiting players alert and clear of the batting area and side walls.
Thrown / dropped bat	Batters must drop the bat, not throw it, and drop it inside the batting square. Any player throwing a bat is warned; repeated throwing means a turn is forfeited.
Equipment condition	Check bats, balls and posts before play. Remove any that are cracked, splintered or damaged. Use sprung or safe-top posts where available.
Slips / hard surfaces	Check floor before play. Remove bags, bottles and loose equipment. Suitable footwear. Stop for spills or an unsafe surface.
Walls / fixed equipment	Set boundaries and restricted areas before play. Keep players clear of walls, doors and stored equipment.
Lighting	Confirm the barn is well lit before play. Stop or move if lighting fails or is too poor to see the ball safely.
Ventilation / temperature	Confirm the barn is adequately ventilated before play. Open doors or vents as needed. Stop or move if the space becomes too hot or stuffy.
Manual handling	Posts and equipment carried and set up by adults or older members using safe lifting. Do not overload; use two people for awkward loads.
Runner / fielder collision	Keep the running route clear. Leaders cannot field on posts or bases

Hazard	Controls
	or stand in the running line.
Behaviour / horseplay	No pushing, barging or horseplay. Umpires and Leaders stop play if behaviour becomes unsafe.
Safeguarding / contact	This is a no-contact sport. Deliberate contact: player disqualified from the game. Three player disqualifications from one team: team disqualified from the game. Temporary match count only; no names retained.
Medical / individual needs	Leaders made aware of any relevant medical conditions in advance. Inhalers, medication and personal needs catered for.
First aid	Group First Aider present. Minimum two Officers. Centre Warden backup.
Incidents	All incidents, injuries or near-misses reported to the Centre Warden.
Crowding / access	Non-playing teams in the waiting area. Keep fire exits and access routes clear at all times.

Risk assessment - Outside pitch

Hazard	Controls
Ground condition	Check the pitch and running route for holes, mud, standing water and debris. Move or stop the game if the surface is unsafe.
Uneven ground / ankle injury	Walk the running route before play and mark or avoid any dips, ruts or raised ground. Watch for turned ankles on soft or rough grass.
Animal fouling / litter	Walk the pitch before play and remove any fouling, glass or litter. Do not play over contaminated ground.
Weather / visibility	Monitor weather and light. Move inside or stop if unsafe. Stop for thunder or lightning.
Sun / UV exposure	Encourage sun cream, hats and use of shade between games. Rotate players out of direct sun where possible.
Heat / hydration	Water available throughout. Use the 10-minute changeover for drinks. Stop play if a player becomes unwell.
Insects / stings	Be aware of wasps, bees and biting insects on grass. Keep any known allergy medication and first aid to hand.
Thrown / dropped bat	Batters must drop the bat, not throw it, and drop it inside the batting square. Any player throwing a bat is warned; repeated throwing means a turn is forfeited.
Equipment condition	Check bats, balls and posts before play. Remove any that are cracked, splintered or damaged. Use sprung or safe-top posts where available.
Bat / ball and boundaries	Mark the playing boundary. Spectators and waiting teams stay outside it and clear of the batting area.
Slips / trips	Suitable footwear for grass. Keep the route around posts and bases clear of bags, bottles and equipment.
Runner / fielder collision	Keep the running route clear. Leaders cannot field on posts or bases or stand in the running line.
Manual handling	Posts and equipment carried and set up by adults or older members using safe lifting. Do not overload; use two people for awkward loads.
Behaviour / horseplay	No pushing, barging or horseplay. Umpires and Leaders stop play if

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Competition standings

Points. Teams earn 3 points for a win, 1 point for a draw and 0 points for a loss. Group positions are decided on total points across the group games.

Tie-break. Teams level on points are separated by rounders difference, then by total rounders scored. If still level, a short tie-break will decide the group position before the final.